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Storage container and system for covering part of a storage container

Abstract

A storage container includes: a container body defining an internal volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system including at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system including at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; and a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively. A system for covering part of a storage container is also provided.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE (1) The present application claims priority from U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/221,538, filed Jul. 14, 2021, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD
(1) The present technology relates to storage containers, and in particular storage containers configured for removable connection to vehicles.
BACKGROUND
(2) Various types of vehicles can be equipped with a storage container to provide a place for storing items on the vehicle. However, typically, such storage containers can be difficult to carry when disconnected from the vehicle which may be desirable for instance if a user wants to dismount the entire contents of the storage container from the vehicle. Furthermore, it is generally desirable to provide a visually appealing aesthetic to the storage container which can be difficult to do when accommodating functional features such as attachment systems that are required for securing the storage container in place.
(3) Therefore, there is a need for a storage container that addresses at least some of these drawbacks.
SUMMARY
(4) It is an object of the present technology to ameliorate at least some of the inconveniences present in the prior art.
(5) In accordance with an aspect of the present technology, there is provided a storage container. The storage container comprises: a container body defining an internal volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system comprising at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system comprising at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; and a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively.
(6) In some embodiments, the at least one first attachment feature is configured for attaching the storage container to a user for carrying of the storage container by the user; and the at least one second attachment feature is configured for attaching the storage container to a vehicle.
(7) In some embodiments, the container body defines an opening for accessing the internal volume; and the opening is disposed at an end of the container body such that the opening is configured to face upward when the storage container is attached to the user.
(8) In some embodiments, the at least one first attachment feature comprises at least one shoulder strap for attaching the storage container to a user.
(9) In some embodiments, the at least one shoulder strap includes two shoulder straps for attaching the storage container on the user's back.
(10) In some embodiments, the at least one second attachment feature comprises at least one anchor for removably attaching the storage container to a vehicle.
(11) In some embodiments, each of the at least one anchor comprises an anchor lock that is moveable between a locked position and an unlocked position to selectively lock the anchor to an anchor fixture connected to the vehicle.
(12) In some embodiments, the at least one first attachment feature is disposed, at least partially, on an opposite side of the container body from the at least one second attachment feature.
(13) In some embodiments, the cover comprises a flap, the cover having a fixed end connected to

the container body, the fixed end being in a same position in the first position and the second position of the cover.
(14) In some embodiments, the storage container further comprises: a first cover fastening feature connected to the container body; and a second cover fastening feature connected to the container body, in the first position, the cover being fastened to the first cover fastening feature, and in the second position, the cover being fastened to the second cover fastening feature.
(15) In some embodiments, the first cover fastening feature is a first zip fastener track; the second cover fastening feature is a second zip fastener track; the cover comprises a peripheral zip fastener track disposed around a periphery of the cover; the storage container further comprises: a first slider for engaging the first zip fastener track with the peripheral zip fastener track, the first slider being slidable along a length of the first zip fastener track and a length of the peripheral zip fastener track for selectively fastening the first zip fastener track to the peripheral zip fastener track; and a second slider for engaging the second zip fastener track with the peripheral zip fastener track, the second slider being slidable along a length of the second zip fastener track and the length of the peripheral zip fastener track for selectively fastening the second zip fastener track to the peripheral zip fastener track; in the first position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the first zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track; and in the second position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the second zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track.
(16) In some embodiments, the internal volume is disposed between the at least one first attachment feature and the at least one second attachment feature.
(17) In some embodiments, a vehicle comprises: a driver seat; a motor for driving the vehicle; and the storage container being selectively attached to the vehicle via the at least one second attachment feature, the cover being in the first position to cover the first attachment system.
(18) According to another aspect of the present technology, there is provided a system for covering part of a storage container. The system comprises: a first zip fastener track configured to be connected to a container body of the storage container; a second zip fastener track configured to be connected to the container body of the storage container; a third zip fastener track configured to be connected to a cover of the storage container; a first slider for engaging the first zip fastener track with the third zip fastener track, the first slider being slidable along a length of the first zip fastener track and a length of the third zip fastener track for selectively fastening the first zip fastener track to the third zip fastener track; and a second slider for engaging the second zip fastener track with the third zip fastener track, the second slider being slidable along a length of the second zip fastener track and the length of the third zip fastener track for selectively fastening the second zip fastener track to the third zip fastener track, in a closed position of the first slider, the first zip fastener track being fastened to the third zip fastener track along the lengths thereof such that the cover is in a first position covering a first attachment system of the container, in a closed position of the second slider, the second zip fastener track being fastened to the third zip fastener track along the lengths thereof such that the cover is in a second position covering a second attachment system of the container.
(19) In some embodiments, in the closed position of the first slider, the second slider is in an open position in which at least a majority of the second zip fastener track is unfastened from the third zip fastener track; and in the closed position of the second slider, the first slider is in an open position in which at least a majority of the first zip fastener track is unfastened from the third zip fastener track.
(20) In some embodiments, each of the first and second zip fastener tracks describes generally U-shaped path.
(21) In some embodiments, the first and second zip fastener tracks are configured to be disposed on opposite sides of the container body.
(22) In some embodiments, a storage container comprises: a container body defining an internal

volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system comprising at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system comprising at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively; and the system for selectively securing the cover in the first position and the second position.
(23) In some embodiments, the third zip fastener track is a peripheral zip fastener track disposed around a periphery of the cover; in the first position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the first zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track; and in the second position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the second zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track.
(24) For purposes of this application, terms related to spatial orientation when referring to the vehicle orientation and positioning of its components such as forwardly, rearwardly, left, and right are as they would normally be understood by a driver of the vehicle sitting thereon in a normal riding position.
(25) Embodiments of the present technology each have at least one of the above-mentioned aspects, but do not necessarily have all of them.
(26) It is to be understood that if there are any discrepancies between definitions in the present application and in documents incorporated by reference herein, definitions in the present application take precedence.
(27) Additional and/or alternative features, aspects, and advantages of embodiments of the present technology will become apparent from the following description, the accompanying drawings, and the appended claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS
(1) For a better understanding of the present technology, as well as other aspects and further features thereof, reference is made to the following description which is to be used in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, where:
(2) FIG. **1** is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, right side, of a vehicle equipped with a storage container according to an embodiment of the present technology;
(3) FIG. **2** is a left side elevation view of a user carrying the storage container of FIG. **1**;
(4) FIG. **3** is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, left side, of the storage container of FIG. **1**, showing a cover of the storage container in an upper position;
(5) FIG. **4** is a rear elevation view of the storage container of FIG. **3**;
(6) FIG. **5** is a top plan view of the storage container of FIG. **3**;
(7) FIG. **6** is a bottom plan view of the storage container of FIG. **3**;
(8) FIG. **7** is a perspective view, taken from a bottom, rear, left side, of the storage container of FIG. **3**, with the cover of the storage container removed for clarity and showing anchor locks of a vehicle attachment system of the storage container in a locked position;
(9) FIG. **8** is a perspective view, taken from a bottom, rear, left side, of the storage container of FIG. **3**, with the cover of the storage container removed for clarity and showing the anchor locks of the vehicle attachment system in an unlocked position;
(10) FIG. **9** is a top plan view of a connection base and anchor fixtures of the vehicle of FIG. **1**;
(11) FIG. **10**A is a perspective view, taken from a rear, right side, of a left anchor fixture of the vehicle of FIG. **1**;

(12) FIG. **10**B is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, left side, of the left anchor fixture of FIG. **10**A;
(13) FIG. **10**C is a top plan view of the left anchor fixture of FIG. **10**A;
(14) FIG. **11** is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, left side, of the storage container of FIG. **1**, shown with the cover thereof unfastened from a container body of the storage container;
(15) FIG. **12** is a rear elevation view of the storage container of FIG. **11**;
(16) FIG. **13** is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, left side, of the storage container of FIG. **1**, showing the cover in a lower position;
(17) FIG. **14** is a rear elevation view of the storage container of FIG. **13**;
(18) FIG. **15** is a top plan view of the storage container of FIG. **13**;
(19) FIG. **16** is a perspective view, taken from a bottom, front, right side, of the storage container of FIG. **13**;
(20) FIG. **17** is a perspective view, taken from a top, rear, right side, of a fastening system of the storage container shown in isolation for clarity;
(21) FIG. **18** is a perspective view of parts of an upper zip fastener track and a peripheral zip fastener track of the fastening system of FIG. **17**;
(22) FIG. **19** is a rear elevation view of parts of the upper zip fastener track, a lower zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track of the fastening system of FIG. **17**, showing an upper slider of the fastening system in a closed position and a lower slider of the fastening system in an open position;
(23) FIG. **20** is a rear elevation view of parts of the upper zip fastener track, the lower zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track of FIG. **17**, showing the peripheral zip fastener track unfastened from the upper and lower zip fastener tracks;
(24) FIG. **21** is a top plan view of the storage container according to an alternative embodiment in which a user attachment system thereof is partially selectively detachable, and shown with the cover thereof unfastened from the container body of the storage container;
(25) FIG. **22** is a bottom plan view of the storage container of FIG. **21**, shown with the cover thereof unfastened from the container body of the storage container;
(26) FIG. **23** is a top plan view of the storage container according to an alternative embodiment, shown with the cover thereof unfastened from the container body of the storage container; and
(27) FIG. **24** is a top plan view of the user attachment system of the storage container of FIG. **21**.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(28) A storage container **10** in accordance with an embodiment of the present technology will be described herein. With reference to FIG. **1**, the storage container **10** is configured to be removably attached to a vehicle **100**. In this embodiment, the vehicle **100** is a road vehicle **100** designed for travel on paved roads. In particular, the vehicle **100** has a frame **112**, two front wheels **114**, a rear wheel **116**, a driver seat **118** supported by the frame **112**, and a motor **120** (illustrated schematically in FIG. **1**) such as an internal combustion engine operatively connected to at least one of the wheels **114**, **116** for driving the vehicle **100**. The vehicle **100** may be any other suitable vehicle in other embodiments, such as an off-road vehicle (e.g., an all-terrain vehicle (ATV), a side-by-side vehicle (SSV), a snowmobile), or a watercraft (e.g., a personal watercraft). The vehicle **100** may thus have ground-engaging members other than wheels (e.g., a track), or even no ground-engaging members in the case of a watercraft.
(29) With reference to FIG. **2** and as will be described in more detail below, the storage container **100** is also configured to be attached to a user **200**. Therefore, when the storage container **10** is detached from the vehicle **100**, the user **200** can carry the storage container **10** on his/her back.
(30) The storage container **10** will now be described with reference to FIGS. **3** to **6**. The storage container **10** has an upper side **14**, a lower side **16**, a left side **18**, a right side **20**, a front side **22** and a rear side **24**. It is to be understood that the nomenclature used herein for describing the sides **14**, **16**, **18**, **20**, **22**, **24** is merely used for consistency with the orientation of the storage container **10**

when it is attached to the vehicle **100** (FIG. **1**). This nomenclature is thus not intended to be limitative as the storage container **10** could be attached to the vehicle **100** in other orientations in other embodiments. Moreover, as shown in FIG. **2**, the storage container **10** has a different orientation when it is attached to the user **200**.

(31) The storage container **10** has a container body **12** having walls defining an internal volume V (shown schematically in FIGS. **4** and **5**) for storing items therein. Different types of items can be stored within the internal volume V as long as the dimensions of the item and/or of the internal volume V permit it. The container body **12** has a generally rectangular box shape in this embodiment, however the container body **12** could have any other suitable shape in other embodiments. The container body **12** can be made of a rigid material (e.g., a plastic shell), a semi-rigid material or a soft material (e.g., a textile). As shown in FIG. **16**, the container body **12** defines an opening **15** for accessing the internal volume V. In this embodiment, the opening **15** is disposed on the right side **20** of the storage container **10**, notably at a right end of the storage container **10**. As such, when the storage container **10** is attached to the user **200**, the opening **15** faces upward. A zip fastener **25** is connected to the container body **12** to selectively open and close the opening **15**.

(32) As shown in FIG. **5**, two handles **23** are connected to front and rear surfaces **27** of the container body **12** on the front and rear sides **22**, **24** of the storage container **10**.

(33) With reference to FIGS. **4** and **6** to **8**, the storage container **10** has a vehicle attachment system **50** for removably attaching the storage container **10** the vehicle **100**. The vehicle attachment system **50** is connected to the container body **12** and, in this embodiment, is disposed on the lower side **16** of the storage container **10**. The vehicle attachment system **50** includes two attachment features **52** which are spaced apart from one another. Notably, a left attachment feature **52** is disposed near a left end of the storage container **10** and a right attachment feature **52** is disposed near a right end of the storage container **10**.

(34) In this embodiment, the attachment features **52** are anchors **52**. As best shown in FIGS. **6** to **8**, each anchor **52** has a frame **45**, an anchor base **54** extending laterally outwardly from the frame **45** and an anchor lock **56** extending below the anchor base **54**, spaced therefrom by a gap **58**. The anchor lock **56** is connected to the anchor base **54** via a stem **60**. A lever **64** is connected to the stem **60** and allows a user to rotate the stem **60** about an axis of the stem **62**, thereby rotating the anchor lock **56**. In particular, the anchor lock **56** is rotatable about the axis of the stem **62** between locked and unlocked positions. In the unlocked position, which is illustrated in FIG. **8**, the anchor lock **56** extends generally parallel to the anchor base **54**. In the locked position which is illustrated in FIGS. **6** and **7**, the anchor lock **56** is rotated by 90° about the axis of the stem **60** relative to the unlocked position. A more complete description of the mechanism of the anchors **52** can be found in U.S. Pat. No. 9,751,592, issued Sep. 5, 2017, the entirety of which is incorporated by reference herein.

(35) As best shown in FIGS. **6** to **8**, in this embodiment, each anchor **52** is connected to the container body **12** via the frame **45**. In particular, the frame **45** is fastened to a lower surface **21** of the container body **12** by fasteners **29** which extend through the frame **45** and into respective openings (not shown) which receive the fasteners **29**. Moreover, in this embodiment, each anchor **52** is at least partly received within a respective recess **65** defined by the lower surface **21** of the container body **12**.

(36) The anchors **52** are configured to be received by corresponding attachment features **110** (FIG. **9**) that are connected to the vehicle **100**. In particular, as shown in FIG. **9**, the attachment features **110** are provided on a connection base **108** (also partially shown in FIG. **1**) that is connected to the frame **112** of the vehicle **100**. As shown in FIG. **1**, in this example, the connection base **108** is disposed behind the driver seat **118**. In this embodiment, the attachment features **110** are left and right anchor fixtures **110** that are connected to the connection base **108** via fasteners **226**. In this embodiment, the left and right anchor fixtures **110** are identical to one another.

(37) With reference to FIGS. **10**A to **10**C, each anchor fixture **110** has a fixture body **210** having a

top portion **212**, a front portion **214**, a left side portion **216**, a right side portion **218** and rear portion **220**, each portion having an interior and an exterior surface. The fixture body **210** also has a base **222**. A pair of fasteners **226** inserted through a pair of fastener holes (not shown) in the fixture body **210** are used to secure the anchor fixture **110** into fastener holes (not shown) defined by an upper surface **109** of the connection base **108**. An anchor aperture **230** is defined by the top portion **212** of the fixture body **210**. The anchor aperture **230** leads downwards through the top portion **212** to an anchor chamber **232** defined by the interior surfaces of the portions **212**, **216**, **218**, **220**. The anchor chamber **232**, below the anchor aperture **230**, extends outwards towards the front portion **214**. The front portion **214** defines a fastener aperture **240** that leads into the anchor chamber **232**. The fastener aperture **240** in the front surface is generally rectangular and defined by three edges **240***a*, **240***b*, **240***c* of the front surface **214** of the fixture body **210**. In this embodiment, the fourth edge of the fastener aperture **240** is defined by the surface on which the anchor fixture **110** is disposed, namely the upper surface **109** of the connection base **108**. It is contemplated that the fastener aperture **240** can be defined wholly by the fixture body **210** or by the fixture body **210** and any other surfaces that the anchor fixture **110** may be engaged with. A more complete description of the anchor fixtures **110** can be found in U.S. Pat. No. 9,751,592.
(38) In order to attach the storage container **10** to the vehicle **100**, the anchor locks **56** of the vehicle attachment system **50** are inserted, in their unlocked positions, into the respective anchor chambers **252** of the anchor fixtures **110** via the anchor apertures **230**. The levers **64** of the anchors **52** are then actuated to rotate the anchor locks **56** to their locked positions. In the locked position of each anchor lock **56**, the anchors **52** are retained by the corresponding anchor fixtures **110**. As such, the storage container **10** is prevented from being removed from the vehicle **100**. If the user then wants to remove the storage container **10** from the vehicle **100**, the anchor locks **56** are rotated to their unlocked positions via the levers **64** and the anchor locks **56** can then be removed from the respective anchor chambers **232** through the anchor apertures **230**.
(39) It is contemplated that, in other embodiments, the anchor fixtures **110** could be replaced by different types of attachment features. For instance, in some embodiments, the connection base **108** could define apertures shaped like the anchor apertures **230** for receiving the anchor locks **56**.
(40) Furthermore, it is contemplated that, in other embodiments, one of the anchors **52** of the vehicle attachment system **50** could be replaced by a different type of attachment feature. For example, in some embodiments, one of the anchors **52** could be replaced by a tongue fastener that is inserted into the anchor chamber **232** of one of the anchor fixtures **210** through the corresponding fastener aperture **240** thereof. Such a configuration of the vehicle attachment system is disclosed in detail in in U.S. Pat. No. 9,751,592.
(41) It is contemplated that the vehicle attachment system **50** could be configured differently in other embodiments.
(42) With reference to FIGS. **13** to **15**, the storage container **10** also has a user attachment system **80** for attaching the storage container **10** to the user **200**. The user attachment system **80** is disposed on the upper side **14** of the storage container **10**. In this embodiment, the user attachment system **80** has two attachment features **82**, different from the anchors **52**, for attaching the storage container **10** to the user **200**. As will be appreciated, the attachment features **82** are disposed on the opposite side of the storage container **10** from the anchors **52**. As such, as shown in FIG. **4**, the internal volume V of the storage container **12** is disposed between the attachment features **82** and the anchors **52**. In this embodiment, the attachment features **82** are shoulder straps **82** connected to an upper surface **19** of the container body **12**. For instance, the shoulder straps **82** could be sewn, welded (e.g., ultrasonically welded), or otherwise fastened to the upper surface **19**. The shoulder straps **82** are oriented so as to extend generally laterally (i.e., in a direction from the left side **18** to the right side **20** of the storage container **10**). As shown in FIG. **2**, the shoulder straps **82** are configured to be looped around the user's arms **202** to attach the storage container **10** on the user's back. The storage container **10** is thus usable as a backpack, providing a simple and reliable way to

carry the storage container **10** when it is detached from the vehicle **100**.
(43) It is contemplated that the user attachment system **80** could be configured differently in other embodiments. For instance, in some embodiments, the user attachment system **80** could be partially or entirely detachably connected to the container body **12** of the storage container **10**. In particular, as shown in FIG. **21**, in an alternative embodiment, buckles **87** are disposed on the upper side **14** of the storage container **10** for selectively connecting respective left ends of the shoulder straps **82** to the container body **12**. In this example, the buckles **87** are male buckles that are disposed near the left end of the container body **12**. Notably, with reference to FIG. **24**, the left ends of the shoulder straps **82** are provided with female buckles **97** that are selectively fastened with the male buckles **87**. The left (free) ends of the shoulder straps **82** may thus be connected or disconnected to the container body **12** via the buckles **87**, **97**. This may facilitate storing the shoulders straps **82** when the cover **40** is positioned to cover the upper side **14** of the storage container **10**. In this example, although the right ends of the shoulder straps **82** are fastened (e.g., sewn or removably attached) to the container body **12** at a central portion **103** (FIG. **24**), right end buckles **83** are also disposed on the upper side **14** of the storage container **10**, spaced from the buckles **87**, to attach the right ends of the shoulder straps **82** thereto. In particular, as shown in FIG. **24**, the right ends of the shoulder straps **82** are provided with male buckles **99** that are selectively fastened with the female buckles **83**. Attaching the shoulder straps **82** to the container body **102** via the buckles **83**, **99** can help support the storage container **10** on the shoulders of the user. In addition, as shown in FIG. **24**, an adjustable strap **105** extends from one of the shoulder straps **82** and is provided with a male chest buckle **98** which is selectively connected to a female chest buckle **107** that is connected to the other shoulder strap **82**. The length of the strap **105** can be selectively adjusted via the male chest buckle **98** to tighten the shoulder straps **82** around a user's chest.
(44) It is contemplated that, in some embodiments, the shoulder straps **82** may be entirely removable from the container body **12**. This may allow the user to remove the user attachment system **80** for instance if the user wishes to use the storage container **10** solely for transport on the vehicle **100**.
(45) With reference now to FIGS. **3** to **5** and **11** to **14**, the storage container **10** is provided with a cover **40** which is movable to selectively cover the vehicle attachment system **50** and the user attachment system **80**. In particular, in this embodiment, the cover **40** is flipped, about a fixed end **42** thereof connected to a left side surface **17** of the container body **12**, between an upper position on the container body **12**, illustrated in FIGS. **3** to **5**, in which the cover **40** is covering the shoulder straps **82** of the user attachment system **80** and a lower position, illustrated in FIGS. **13** and **14**, in which the cover **40** is covering the anchors **52** of the vehicle attachment system **50**.
(46) As best shown in FIGS. **17**, **21** and **22**, a fastening system **55** is provided to secure the cover **40** to the container body **12** in the upper and lower positions. Notably, an upper cover fastening feature **44** and a lower cover fastening feature **46** are provided on the container body **12** to fasten the cover **40** thereto in the upper and lower positions respectively. In this embodiment, the fastening system **55** is a zip fastener system such that the upper and lower cover fastening features **44**, **46** are upper and lower zip fastener tracks **44**, **46** connected to the container body **12**. The upper zip fastener track **44** is connected to the container body **12** on the upper side **14** of the storage container **10** and the lower zip fastener track **46** is connected to the container body **12** on the lower side **16** of the storage container **10**. The fastening system **55** also includes a peripheral zip fastener track **48** disposed around a periphery **43** of the cover **40** and fastenable with either of the upper and lower zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**. In this embodiment, each of the zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**, **48** describes a generally U-shaped path.
(47) An example of parts of the upper zip fastener track **44** and the peripheral zip fastener track **48** is shown in FIG. **18**. It should be understood that the lower zip fastener track **46** is configured similarly and is engageable with the peripheral zip fastener track **48** in the same manner. As can be seen, each of the zip fastener tracks **44**, **48** has a plurality of teeth **51** (sometimes referred to as

“elements”). In this embodiment, the teeth **51** of each of the zip fastener tracks **44**, **48** are connected to a tape member **53** which is in turn connected to the container body **12** for the upper zip fastener tracks **44** or to a body of the cover **40** for the peripheral zip fastener track **48**. The teeth **51** of the upper zip fastener track **44** and the teeth **51** of the peripheral zip fastener track **48** are meshed with each other by a slider **57**. Notably, the slider **57** is slidable over the teeth **51**, along a length of the upper zip fastener track **44** and a length of the peripheral zip fastener track **48** for selectively fastening the upper zip fastener track **44** to the peripheral zip fastener track **48**. In a closed position of the slider **57**, the upper zip fastener track **44** is fastened to the peripheral zip fastener track **48** along the lengths thereof such that the cover **40** is in the upper position (FIGS. **3** to **5**) covering the user attachment system **80**. A pull **59** is connected to the slider **57** for pulling by the user's fingers in order to actuate the slider **57**. A bottom stop **61** prevents the slider **57** from entirely disengaging the upper and peripheral zip fastener tracks **44**, **48**.
(48) As will be appreciated, the lower zip fastener track **46** is also fastenable with the peripheral zip fastener track **48** in the same manner via another slider **57** which joins or separates their respective teeth **51** such that, in a closed position of that slider **57**, the lower zip fastener track **46** is fastened to the peripheral zip fastener track **48** along the lengths thereof such that the cover **40** is in the lower position (FIGS. **13**, **14**) covering the vehicle attachment system **50**.
(49) In this embodiment, the peripheral zip fastener track **48** thus always remains engaged with both the upper and lower zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**. However, when the slider **57** that engages the upper and peripheral zip fastener tracks **44**, **48** (which can be referred to as the “upper slider” **57**) is in the closed position, the other slider **57** (hereinafter the “lower slider”) is in an open position in which a majority or an entirety of the lower zip fastener track **46** is unfastened from the peripheral zip fastener track **48** in order to allow the cover **40** to be folded toward the opposite side of the storage container **10**. This is illustrated for example in FIG. **19** which illustrates corresponding end portions of the upper, lower and peripheral zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**, **48**. In FIG. **19**, the lower slider **57** (which engages the lower and peripheral zip fastener tracks **46**, **48**) is shown in the open position, and the upper slider **57** is shown in the closed position such that the upper and peripheral zip fastener tracks **44**, **48** are fastened to one another along a majority of their respective lengths. In FIG. **20**, the lower slider **57** is still in the open position and the upper slider **57** (not illustrated in FIG. **20**) is also in its open position such that the peripheral zip fastener track **48** is unfastened from both the upper and lower zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**.
(50) Similarly, when the lower slider **57** is in the closed position, the upper slider **57** is in an open position in which a majority or an entirety of the upper zip fastener track **44** is unfastened from the peripheral zip fastener track **48**.
(51) It is contemplated that, in other embodiments, the peripheral zip fastener track **48** could be entirely disengaged from both the upper and lower zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**. For instance, in such embodiments, the bottom stops **61** of each of the zip fastener tracks would be omitted and upper and lower insert pins could be provided at opposite ends of the peripheral zip fastener track **48** so that the peripheral zip fastener track **48** can be inserted and removed from the upper and lower sliders **57**.
(52) As will be appreciated, the fastening system **55** as described above has few components and therefore is easy to use and can be inexpensive to implement while offering few possibilities for malfunction.
(53) Furthermore, it is contemplated that the fastening system **55** could have different fastening features than the zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**, **48** described above. For instance, in some embodiments, the fastening features could be hook and loop fastening features, buckles and/or snap closures. For example, as shown in FIG. **23**, in an alternative embodiment, rather than the zip fastener tracks **44**, **46**, **48**, the fastening system **55** includes a cover buckle **48′** and a container body buckle **44′** respectively connected to the cover **40** and the container body **12** of the storage container **10**. As can be seen, in this example, the container body buckle **44′** is disposed on the right

side **20** of the storage container **10** and the cover buckle **48′** extends from an end of the cover **40** that, when the cover **40** is fastened to the container body **12**, is on the right side **20** of the storage container **10**. Thus, when the cover **40** is positioned in place either on the upper side **14** or the lower side **16**, the buckles **44′**, **48′** are selectively engaged with each other to fasten the cover **40** to cover either the upper side **14** or the lower side **16**. It is contemplated that additional buckles may be provided in other implementations. In addition, in this example, the fastening system **55** also includes male snaps **49′** disposed on the cover **40** and female snaps **51′** disposed on the upper side **14** and the lower side **16** (only the snaps **51′** on the upper side **14** being shown in FIG. **23**). In particular, three male snaps **49′** are disposed on each side of the cover **40**, and three female snaps **51′** are disposed on each of the upper side **14** and the lower side **16**. The male snaps **49′** are engaged with the female snaps **51′** to fasten the cover **40** such as to cover the upper side **14** or the lower side **16** of the storage container **10**. It is contemplated that the snaps **49′**, **51′** or the buckles **44′**, **48′** could be omitted in other examples of implementation.

(54) As will be appreciated, the fastening system **55** for securing the cover **40** in place is easy to use and allows the cover **40** to stay in place to selectively conceal the vehicle attachment system **50** and the user attachment system **80**. As such, the storage container **10** is provided with an aesthetically appealing look despite having the attachment systems **50**, **80** on opposite sides thereof. The user **200** can therefore carry the storage container **10** as a backpack as shown in FIG. **2** while concealing the vehicle attachment system **50** to provide a more natural backpack look to the storage container **200**. Moreover, the provision of the actuatable vehicle attachment system **50** provides a quick and effective way of securing the storage container **10** onto the vehicle **100**.

(55) Furthermore, while the attachment system **80** in the present embodiment is configured for attaching the storage container **10** to the user **200**, it is contemplated that, in other embodiments, the attachment system **80** could be a different type of attachment system. For instance, in some embodiments, the attachment system **80** could be another vehicle attachment system, different from the vehicle attachment system **50**. For example, the attachment system **80** could have attachment features that are different from the anchors **52** to accommodate connection to different types of attachment features on the vehicle. This may allow the storage container **10** to be removably attached to vehicles implementing different types of attachment features.

(56) Modifications and improvements to the above-described embodiments of the present technology may become apparent to those skilled in the art. The foregoing description is intended to be exemplary rather than limiting. The scope of the present technology is therefore intended to be limited solely by the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A storage container, comprising: a container body defining an internal volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system comprising at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system comprising at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively, the cover including a peripheral zip fastener track disposed around a periphery of the cover; a first cover fastening feature connected to the container body, the first cover fastening feature being a first zip fastener track; a first slider for engaging the first zip fastener track with the peripheral zip fastener track, the first slider being slidable along a length of the first zip fastener track and a length of the peripheral zip fastener track for selectively fastening the first zip fastener track to the peripheral zip fastener track; a second cover fastening feature connected to the container body, the second cover fastening

feature being a second zip fastener track; and a second slider for engaging the second zip fastener track with the peripheral zip fastener track, the second slider being slidable along a length of the second zip fastener track and the length of the peripheral zip fastener track for selectively fastening the second zip fastener track to the peripheral zip fastener track, in the first position, the periphery of the cover being fastened to the container body via engagement between the first zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track, in the second position, the periphery of the cover being fastened to the container body via engagement between the second zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track.

2. The storage container of claim 1, wherein: the at least one first attachment feature is configured for attaching the storage container to a user for carrying of the storage container by the user; and the at least one second attachment feature is configured for attaching the storage container to a vehicle.

3. The storage container of claim 2, wherein: the container body defines an opening for accessing the internal volume; and the opening is disposed at an end of the container body such that the opening is configured to face upward when the storage container is attached to the user.

4. The storage container of claim 1, wherein the at least one first attachment feature comprises at least one shoulder strap for attaching the storage container to a user.

5. The storage container of claim 4, wherein the at least one shoulder strap includes two shoulder straps for attaching the storage container on the user's back.

6. The storage container of claim 1, wherein the at least one second attachment feature comprises at least one anchor for removably attaching the storage container to a vehicle.

7. The storage container of claim 6, wherein each of the at least one anchor comprises an anchor lock that is moveable between a locked position and an unlocked position to selectively lock the at least one anchor to an anchor fixture connected to the vehicle.

8. The storage container of claim 1, wherein the at least one first attachment feature is disposed, at least partially, on an opposite side of the container body from the at least one second attachment feature.

9. The storage container of claim 1, wherein the cover comprises a flap, the cover having a fixed end connected to the container body, the fixed end being in a same position in the first position and the second position of the cover.

10. The storage container of claim 1, wherein the internal volume is disposed between the at least one first attachment feature and the at least one second attachment feature.

11. A vehicle, comprising: a driver seat; a motor for driving the vehicle; and the storage container of claim 1, the storage container being selectively attached to the vehicle via the at least one second attachment feature, the cover being in the first position to cover the first attachment system.

12. A system for covering part of a storage container, comprising: a first zip fastener track configured to be connected to a container body of the storage container; a second zip fastener track configured to be connected to the container body of the storage container; a third zip fastener track configured to be connected to a cover of the storage container; a first slider for engaging the first zip fastener track with the third zip fastener track, the first slider being slidable along a length of the first zip fastener track and a length of the third zip fastener track for selectively fastening the first zip fastener track to the third zip fastener track; and a second slider for engaging the second zip fastener track with the third zip fastener track, the second slider being slidable along a length of the second zip fastener track and the length of the third zip fastener track for selectively fastening the second zip fastener track to the third zip fastener track, in a closed position of the first slider, the first zip fastener track being fastened to the third zip fastener track along the lengths thereof such that the cover is in a first position covering a first attachment system of the storage container, in a closed position of the second slider, the second zip fastener track being fastened to the third zip fastener track along the lengths thereof such that the cover is in a second position covering a second attachment system of the storage container.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein: in the closed position of the first slider, the second slider is in an open position in which at least a majority of the second zip fastener track is unfastened from the third zip fastener track; and in the closed position of the second slider, the first slider is in an open position in which at least a majority of the first zip fastener track is unfastened from the third zip fastener track.
14. The system of claim 12, wherein each of the first and second zip fastener tracks describes a generally U-shaped path.
15. The system of claim 12, wherein the first and second zip fastener tracks are configured to be disposed on opposite sides of the container body.
16. A storage container, comprising: a container body defining an internal volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system comprising at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system comprising at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively; and the system of claim 12 for selectively securing the cover in the first position and the second position.
17. The storage container of claim 16, wherein: the third zip fastener track is a peripheral zip fastener track disposed around a periphery of the cover; in the first position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the first zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track; and in the second position, the periphery of the cover is fastened to the container body via engagement between the second zip fastener track and the peripheral zip fastener track.
18. A storage container, comprising: a container body defining an internal volume for storing items therein; a first attachment system connected to the container body, the first attachment system comprising at least one first attachment feature for attaching the storage container; a second attachment system connected to the container body, the second attachment system comprising at least one second attachment feature for attaching the storage container, the at least one second attachment feature being different from the at least one first attachment feature; a cover moveable between a first position and a second position on the container body to selectively cover the first attachment system and the second attachment system respectively; a first cover fastening feature connected to the container body; and a second cover fastening feature connected to the container body, in the first position, the cover being fastened to the first cover fastening feature, in the second position, the cover being fastened to the second cover fastening feature.